BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. **GREEN PEN** Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

Computer Misuse Act 1990

Name _____ **Class** _____ **Date** _____ **Time** _____ **Teacher** _____

Do Now - Four retrieval questions

BLACK PEN: answer four questions before checking the answers.

1. What is the purpose of the Data Protection Act 2018?

2. How many bytes are in 72 bits?

A) 18 bytes
B) 9 bytes
C) 72 bytes
D) 576 bytes

3. A text file contains 180 characters. The stated encoding uses 8 bits per character. Calculate its raw size in bits and bytes.

4. A microphone records digital sound. "Sampling stores every instant of the sound wave." Correct this. How does it affect recorded detail?

Today's objectives

Explain the overall purpose of the Computer Misuse Act 1990. Recognise unauthorised access and unauthorised harmful acts.

Key vocabulary - Read, cover, recall

Computer Misuse Act 1990
UK law targeting unauthorised computer access and related misuse.

Unauthorised access
Entering or using computer material without permission.

Authorisation
Permission to access or use a system.

Computer offence
An action prohibited by criminal law involving computer systems.

Write one key term and its meaning in your own words:

Do Now	I Do	We Do	You Do	Review & Improve
Recall previous learning	Read new knowledge	Practise with guidance	Work independently	Check my understanding

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. **GREEN PEN** Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

Learn and practise

New learning - Key ideas

Purpose of the law	The Computer Misuse Act 1990 makes certain actions against computer systems unlawful, including access without permission.
Unauthorised access	Accessing computer material without authorisation can be an offence, even if the person does not steal information. Knowing a password does not by itself grant permission.
Further criminal intent	Unauthorised access with intent to commit or facilitate another offence is a more serious form of computer misuse.
Damaging or disrupting systems	Unauthorised acts that impair a system-such as deliberately causing harmful disruption or altering data without permission-can be offences. Authorised security testing must stay within a lawful agreed scope.

I Do - One worked example

A student guesses a teacher's password and opens restricted files without permission, but changes nothing. Explain why this may be an offence under the Computer Misuse Act 1990. [4 marks]

1. Identify the action: deliberately accessing another person's account.

2. The student gains access to computer material [1] without permission [1].

3. The Computer Misuse Act covers unauthorised access [1] even if no data is modified or deleted [1].

4. Do not incorrectly claim that a file must be damaged before unauthorised access becomes unlawful.

We Do - Guided questions

BLACK PEN: use the model, then explain your answer.

1. An employee opens confidential HR records using a colleague's password without permission. Explain why knowing the password does not make the access lawful. [4 marks]

2. A person deliberately changes a shared database so the service stops working. Explain which kind of computer misuse is involved and one effect. [4 marks]

3. A school hires an expert to test its website security. Explain TWO reasons written permission and a defined scope are important. [4 marks]

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. **GREEN PEN** Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

Think and write

Code First - Predict > Write > Test > Improve

YOUR TASK: Predict the simulated authorisation decision.

```
authorised = false
if authorised then
print("Allow")
else
print("Deny")
endif
```

BLACK PEN: predict or complete the code; test, then improve.

You Do - Independent exam questions

Q2. State one action prohibited by the Computer Misuse Act 1990. [1 mark]

Q3. A pupil opens another pupil's school account without permission but does not delete any work. Explain why this can still be computer misuse. [4 marks]

Q4. Compare unauthorised access, access with further criminal intent, and unauthorised damage/disruption under the Computer Misuse Act. [6 marks]

Exit Ticket - True or False?

Circle T or F before reviewing Page 4.

1. Accessing someone else's account without permission can be unlawful even if no files are deleted. ☐ T ☐ F

2. The Computer Misuse Act 1990 makes certain actions against computer systems unlawful, including access w... ☐ T ☐ F

3. Accessing computer material without authorisation can be an offence, even if the person does not steal i... ☐ T ☐ F

BLACK PEN Answer all questions first. **GREEN PEN** Then: tick correct answers; rewrite mistakes.

Review & improve

GREEN PEN: tick correct marking points, then correct errors.

Choose your hardest question to rewrite in full below.

Do Now - Answers

Q1 It sets rules for using personal data lawfully and protects people's rights. ☐

Q2 B - 9 bytes ☐

Q3 1,440 bits and 180 bytes. ☐

Q4 Measure amplitude at regular intervals. Store each rounded (quantised) value in binary. Sample rate and bit depth limit the detail captured. ☐

Code First - Model

```
authorised = false
if authorised then
print("Allow")
else
print("Deny")
endif
```

Output: Deny

We Do - Check the model

1. The employee uses an account to access restricted computer records [1] without being authorised [1]. Knowing a password is not permission [1], so the access may breach the Computer Misuse Act [1]. ☐

2. The changes were unauthorised [1] and impair the operation of the system [1]. This can amount to a Computer Misuse Act offence [1], and legitimate users may be unable to access the service/data [1]. ☐

3. Permission shows the tester is authorised [1] and distinguishes the agreed test from unauthorised access [1]. A defined scope identifies permitted systems and actions [1], preventing the tester from exceeding authorisation [1]. ☐

Exit Ticket - Check

1. TRUE 2. TRUE 3. TRUE

You Do - Self-mark

Q2 Accessing a computer/system without authorisation [1]. ☐

Q3 The account contains computer material [1], which the pupil deliberately accessed [1] without permission [1]. Unauthorised access is prohibited even without deleting or modifying data [1]. ☐

Q4 Unauthorised access is entering computer material without permission [2]. Access with intent to commit another offence adds criminal purpose [2]. Deliberate unauthorised acts impairing systems/data can disrupt operation [2]. Apply examples accurately without assuming legitimate security testing is unlawful. ☐

Try the question again

1. Copy the FULL question you found most difficult:

2. In GREEN PEN, write a complete new answer: